

entered Babylon. *Harine* (?) were carried before him. Prosperity was established in the city; Cyrus decreed prosperity for all in Babylon. Gobryas, his governor, placed governors in charge of Babylon. From Kislev to Adar the gods of Akkad, whom Nabonidus had brought up to Babylon, they returned to their cities." There follow, as Dougherty notes, the death of a prominent personage and a period of mourning, in the following fragmentary lines: "In the month Marchesvan, on the night of the 11th, Ugbaru . . . In the month (?) the . . . of the king died. From the 28th day of Adar to the third day of Nisan there was weeping in the land of Akkad. . . . All the people prostrated their heads." Who this personage was is quite doubtful; most scholars, while recognizing the uncertainty, have filled the lacuna with 'the son [of the king],' *i.e.*, Belsh.; so, *e.g.*, King, Barton, Clay, Bouffflower (p. 129), and Dougherty earlier; but the latter now does not venture to fill the gap. He writes later on: "Accurate interpretation . . . is impossible owing to the illegible condition of the text. However, there is strong probability that Belsh. was slain in connection with the fall of Babylon, as indicated in the fifth chapter of Daniel and intimated by the record of Xenophon." On this point the writer admires Dougherty's candid scepticism, for he himself must enter a demurrer against the theory that the conqueror's own record could have so distinguished the death of a prince who was, when free and alive, a hopeless rebel.

How and where Belsh. came to his end we do not learn from the Akk. documents. But some Gr. data, which have often been alleged as history, must be considered. Herodotus, i, 191, describes at length Cyrus' capture of Babylon. According to his story the city had been stoutly fortified and provisioned against Cyrus' attack. But the latter diverted the Euphrates into a great basin, which had been made by Neb.'s queen Nitocris when she was building the water-walls of the city; and by this dry channel he entered the city unawares (by night?—although this is not stated), "as they were engaged in a festival, dancing and revelling until they learned of the capture but too surely." The story is paralleled by a much longer narrative in Xenophon's *Cyropaedia*, vii, 5 (noticed above under the title 'Darius the Mede'). Cyrus formed the plan of draining off the river into a trench which he had dug; he drained off the waters on a night